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CONTACT ONE-SHEET · BENTLEY SYSTEMS · SEPTEMBER 15, 2026

**Greg Bentley**

Executive Chairman (co-founder)

**\$1.5B (FY2025)**

Revenue

**Exton**

HQ

## 01 Who You're Meeting

**Greg Bentley** — Executive Chairman (co-founder), Bentley Systems.

**In role:** Executive Chair since 1 July 2024; previously Chairman and CEO from 1995

**Today:** Board leadership and continuity of what he calls the company's engineering ethos, following the handover of executive control to Nicholas Cumins.

The eldest of the five brothers who founded Bentley Systems in 1984 and the person who ran it for nearly thirty years. The brothers redefined what was then computer-aided design by building MicroStation as a platform for engineering applications; four decades and more than 120 acquisitions later the company is the leading provider of infrastructure engineering software, used to design, build and operate critical infrastructure worldwide. He served as Chairman and CEO from 1995, took the company public in 2020, and stepped back to Executive Chair in 2024 under a planned transition.

**Career:** Executive Chair of the Board, Bentley Systems; Chairman & Chief Executive Officer, Bentley Systems; Co-founder (eldest of five founding brothers), Bentley Systems

**The company:** Profitable, public infrastructure-software incumbent with a 40-year design-through-operations footprint — the closest thing to an "establishment" peer for Sand's water/energy/transport verticals, and the best-rated employer on this list by its own staff.

**What they sell:** iTwin Platform (infrastructure digital twins), AssetWise (asset/network performance), ProjectWise (project delivery), SYNCHRO (construction management) and MicroStation-based design tools; 41,000+ accounts in ~195 countries.

## 02 Where The Company Sits

Strong overlap with Sand on infrastructure asset lifecycle and digital twins, but Bentley's roots are in engineering design software (CAD-first) rather than real-time operational AI control.

## 03 Talking Points

- Founder with a board seat and stated intent to stay involved — influence beyond what the title suggests.
- Forty years of institutional memory on infrastructure engineering software; the right person for a long-horizon or category-level conversation.
- Route commercial and roadmap discussion through Cumins; use Greg Bentley for strategic weight.

**What to pressure-test about the company:**

- AI narrative is "emerging," not core — lags Palantir/C3.ai/Cognite on generative and agentic AI maturity
- Dual-class share structure keeps the founding family in control, limiting activist or outside investor influence
- CAD/engineering-design heritage means real-time operational AI control is a newer, less-proven muscle than for Sand or Cognite

## 04 GIP Context

**GIP:** No named GIP portfolio company was confirmed as a Bentley customer, though Bentley's customer base of government transportation agencies and infrastructure owner-operators plausibly overlaps with GIP-owned airports, ports and rail (Bentley's software is near-ubiquitous in civil infrastructure engineering)

**BlackRock:** Confirmed — 5.4% of shares outstanding per a July 2026 Schedule 13G/A, making BlackRock Bentley's largest institutional holder outside the founding Bentley family, which retains majority voting control via dual-class shares.

**Others at Bentley Systems:** Nicholas Cumins (Chief Executive Officer)

[www.bentley.com](http://www.bentley.com) · [CEO transition announcement](#) · [ENR interview](#) · [Company LinkedIn](#)

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